MARTA KOWAL-BRANDT

DevOps / Platform Engineering | CI/CD & Test Infrastructure

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

QA automation and test-infrastructure engineer with experience owning CI/CD for three product teams, designing ephemeral Kubernetes test environments, and building automation and observability tooling. Hands-on with Docker, Helm, Kubernetes at namespace level on a shared cluster for test environments, and Terraform in a personal Hetzner project; currently developing broader Kubernetes administration and cloud-infrastructure capability. Applying CI/CD, infrastructure-as-code, observability, and ephemeral-environment experience toward DevOps and platform engineering.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

CI/CD and automation: GitLab CI, Jenkins, pipeline optimization, artifact publishing, automated test workflows
Containers and orchestration: Docker, Docker Compose, Helm, Kubernetes (namespace-level access; test environments), k3s (personal homelab)
Infrastructure as Code and Operations: Terraform (personal Hetzner project), Ansible (basic), Linux, Git, PostgreSQL
Monitoring and observability: Prometheus, Grafana, Loki; Grafana dashboards for CI/test metrics; test-result collection via Python, PostgreSQL, and GitLab API
Programming and scripting: Python, Bash, Java (test code), SQL
Testing: pytest, Playwright, Selenium, Postman
Cloud learning: AWS EC2 and S3 basics (personal learning)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

QA Automation Engineer (Test Infrastructure) | Odrava Health Software | Wroclaw *2021–Present*

- Owned GitLab CI pipeline design and maintenance for three product teams (~25 developers), covering build, unit, integration, and end-to-end testing stages and artifact publishing.
- Reduced average pipeline duration from 38 to 14 minutes by profiling workflows, parallelizing test jobs, caching dependencies and separating end-to-end testing into its own stage; monthly CI runner costs fell by about 30%.
- Designed and implemented short-lived merge-request environments containing the application, PostgreSQL, seeded data, and automated end-to-end execution; deployed through GitLab CI and Helm to the shared Kubernetes cluster and automatically removed after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.
- Enabled QA and product stakeholders to review features before merge through per-merge-request application environments with seeded PostgreSQL data and automated end-to-end tests.
- Maintain a pytest and Playwright end-to-end suite of approximately 900 tests; reduced the flaky-test rate from 7% to below 1%.
- Built test-result collection and Grafana dashboards using Python, PostgreSQL and the GitLab API to help teams identify flaky-test patterns.
- Wrote Bash and Python tooling to seed PostgreSQL test data.
- Authored an internal guide to CI workflows used in team onboarding; mentored two QA interns in 2023.

QA Engineer | Brightmill Software House | Wroclaw *2019–2021*

- Tested web and mobile applications for client projects using manual and automated approaches.
- Introduced a Java and Selenium automated regression suite for the largest client project.
- Configured Jenkins jobs to run nightly regression tests.

Customer Support Specialist (2nd line) | Brightmill Software House *2018–2019*

- Investigated customer issues using logs and databases and reproduced bugs for developers.

SELECTED INFRASTRUCTURE PROJECTS

Homelab k3s Cluster with GitOps | Personal *2024–2025*

- Built and operated a three-node Raspberry Pi 5 k3s cluster for personal learning, deploying applications from

Git with Argo CD.

- Implemented personal observability and ingress components with Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, Traefik, and cert-manager for TLS certificate management.
- Provisioned infrastructure for a small Hetzner VPS using Terraform; used Ansible at a basic level.

Merge-Request Ephemeral Environments | Odrava Health *2023–2024*

- Designed and implemented per-merge-request test environments containing the application, PostgreSQL, seeded data, and automated end-to-end test execution.
- Automated environment deployment through GitLab CI and Helm, and automatic cleanup after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.

CI Pipeline Speed-up | Odrava Health *2022*

- Profiled CI pipelines across three teams, parallelized test jobs, introduced dependency caching and split end-to-end testing into a separate stage.
- Reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes and monthly CI runner costs by about 30%.

EDUCATION

BEng, Computer Engineering | Silesian Lowlands University of Technology | 2018

CERTIFICATIONS AND PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

ISTQB Foundation Level | 2019
Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) preparation; exam scheduled for January 2027 (not yet certified)

LANGUAGES

Polish (native) | English (C1) | German (A2)